

Muncie City Council October 6th, 2025

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=EljQqzO9yIA
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Comprehensive Municipal Meeting Report

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding Officer President Mason called the regular meeting to order on October 6, 2025 (00:15:30).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Mr. Dishman, Miss [Name/Golia], Mr. Macintosh, Mr. Green, Miss Pal, Mr. Garrett, Miss Selby, Miss Williams, and President Mason. (Note: Councilman Garrett was noted as absent later in the meeting during procedural budget actions).
 - **Members Absent:** None initially, though Councilman Garrett left the room prior to later agenda items.
 - **Presiding Officer:** President Mason.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance led by Councilman Green (00:15:30), followed by an invocation led by Councilman Green (00:16:05). A Citizen Recognition Award was presented by Councilman Green to longtime Muncie band director and music educator John Clark for 39+ years of service (00:17:13).

- **Approval of Minutes:** Motion to approve the minutes of the September meeting was made by Miss Selby and seconded by Mr. Macintosh (00:30:52). Following discussion regarding voice vs. roll call, a formal roll call vote was conducted, passing unanimously (00:31:14).
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:34:23 Motion to Delay Action on Budget Ordinances (Ordinances 30-25, 31-25, and 32-25)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Miss Pal.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Motion to delay action on the three budget ordinances and reconvene the meeting on Thursday, October 16, at 7:00 PM solely for the budget ordinances, due to Councilman Garrett's absence (as remote electronic voting for appropriations is restricted under current rules).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed by Roll Call Vote (00:35:41).
- **00:38:05 Ordinance 26-25: Zoning Amendment (1600 N. Wheeling Ave.)**
 - **Item Identifier & Title:** Ordinance 26-25 <U+2014> An ordinance to amend the City of Muncie comprehensive zoning ordinance from R-4 Residential Zone to BC Community Business Zone for premises located at 1600 N. Wheeling Ave.
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Belinda Hughes (Business Owner).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The applicant explained plans to move a specialty toy store ("Be Coco") featuring sensory-friendly toys and a dad/baby line to the location. Council members discussed neighbor notifications, limited parking hours, and potential neighborhood impacts.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** Belinda Hughes spoke in favor of the project (00:38:05).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to adopt made by Miss Pal, seconded by Mr. Basham (00:39:15). Tabled/Delayed via subsequent motion. (*Note: Formal final vote recorded later via roll call*).
- **00:46:13 Ordinance 27-25: Zoning Amendment (718 N. Walnut St.)**
 - **Item Identifier & Title:** Ordinance 27-25 <U+2014> An ordinance to amend the comprehensive zoning ordinance from R-5 Residential to BC Central Business Zone at 718 N. Walnut St.
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jonathan Chandler (Co-owner).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Co-owner Jonathan Chandler appeared to answer questions. Council noted neighborhood support.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** Jonathan Chandler spoke in favor (00:46:42). Public commenter noted procedural questions regarding readings.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to adopt made by Miss Pal, seconded by Miss Selby (00:46:31). Approved by Roll Call Vote (00:48:15).

- **00:48:37 Ordinance 29-25: Traffic Schedules (University Avenue Parking & Bike Lanes)**

- **Item Identifier & Title:** Ordinance 29-25 <U+2014> An ordinance amending Chapter 80 traffic schedules of the Muncie Code of Ordinances regarding University Avenue parking.
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mayor Dan Ridenour / City Administration.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Mayor Ridenour read a letter of support from Ball State University detailing a \$1 million Lily Endowment grant to create a protected bike lane and physical connection between the Village and downtown Muncie, featuring traffic calming and BSU-funded maintenance. Extensive debate occurred regarding parking loss, neighborhood historic character, alternative routes, safety data, and parking utilization surveys.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:**
 - Cameron Grubs (01:01:20) questioned survey methodology and grant contingencies.
 - Jeremy Reese (01:34:52) spoke regarding bike route usage.
 - Seth Rollins (01:57:47) supported bike lanes with enhanced physical protection.
 - Beth Mesner (01:07:35) spoke on behalf of personal concerns regarding the Riverside Normal City neighborhood, historic character, and parking congestion.
 - Janna Oliver (01:15:40) questioned intersection safety.
 - Melinda Messino (01:20:30) suggested compromising by starting with crosswalks, trees, and lighting while pausing the parking removal.
 - Zayn Bishop (01:20:57) supported bike lanes and noted underutilized street parking.
 - Franklin Gray (01:24:44) questioned alternative bike path locations.
 - Helen McPherson (01:27:14) supported bike lanes while advocating for compromise and speed enforcement.
 - Tanya Aside (01:29:54) (Muncie Arts and Culture Council) clarified support for artistic crosswalks.
 - Garrett (01:31:19) (Muncie Downtown Development Partnership chair) spoke in favor of the ordinance to link the campus and downtown.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to table made by Councilman Green, seconded by Councilman Basham (01:33:59). Passed by Roll Call Vote (01:34:44).

- **00:37:43 Ordinance 33-25: Alley Vacation (Kirby's Addition, Block 15)**

- **Item Identifier & Title:** Ordinance 33-25 <U+2014> An ordinance vacating a part of an alley located in Block 15 of C.H. Kirby's Addition.
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Kathy Ben Ice (Ashton Land Surveyor).
- **Deliberation Summary:** Surveyor explained the request to vacate a landlocked sliver of an alley to allow a homeowner to rebuild a garage. Utilities have signed off.

- **Item-Specific Public Input:** Kathy Ben Ice presented the petition (00:01:46 / 01:38:19).
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion for introduction made by Miss Pal, seconded by Mr. Green (01:38:00). Approved by Roll Call Vote (01:39:56).
- **01:40:21 Resolution 17-25: Fire Station Project Financing & Taxpayer Petition**
 - **Item Identifier & Title:** Resolution 17-25 <U+2014> A resolution relating to the financing of a fire station project and approving a form of taxpayer petition.
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Councilman Basham / Administration.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Council discussed confusion regarding the re-filing of the resolution after it was previously withdrawn by Councilman Basham, noting it was re-submitted via the Mayor's office without proper council sponsorship/signatures. Legal counsel representatives attempted to speak but were deferred due to lack of valid introduction.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Removed from consideration / Not introduced due to lack of valid sponsorship/signatures (01:41:46).

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **01:45:00 Courtney Marsh:** Invited the community to a local event on October 28 at Ball Court Park honoring local law enforcement, sheriff's department, and parks department.
 - **01:46:46 Janetta Presley:** Provided updates on the "Laundry for Kids" program (8,000 lbs of laundry completed) and ongoing community meal programs at Aenddale United Methodist Church, requesting continued funding.
 - **01:48:20 Cheryl Titchen:** Raised ongoing concerns regarding code enforcement, unaddressed property blight/trash at 1516 W. 13th Street, and an animal control dispute following a dog bite incident. (Referred to unsafe housing authority follow-up).
 - **01:55:17 Cameron Grubs:** Criticized communication transparency between the administration and council, budget documentation clarity, and insurance policy changes affecting employees.
 - **01:58:52 Christopher Bilbury:** Alleged an Open Door Law violation regarding pre-meeting discussions on budget postponement dates, criticized communication gaps from elected officials regarding email responses, and urged better meeting preparedness.
 - **02:05:03 Audi Barber:** Addressed public safety salary increases versus city budget shortfalls, urging the council to exercise stronger financial checks on mayoral spending.
 - **02:09:06 Wayne [Last Name Inaudible]:** Expressed initial confusion over the budget meeting delay, thanked council members for explaining the legal and financial necessity of protecting incoming EDIT and local income tax funds against reversion to 2025 budgets, and offered political commentary.
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:** President Mason and council members reminded attendees that the current meeting will not adjourn tonight, but will instead stand in recess and reconvene on **Thursday, October 16, 2025, at 7:00 PM** solely to consider and vote on the budget ordinances (Ordinances 30-25, 31-25, and 32-25) (02:14:57).
- **Adjournment:** The meeting was recessed/continued pursuant to prior action to the October 16, 2025 special session (02:14:57).

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